itself to untoward security risk," with reference to India's decision on Huawei's involvement in their 5G network.[25] Two months later, however, in December 2019, India included Huawei in its 5G trials, a decision which has created domestic debate.[26]

Bilateral and multilateral diplomatic engagement

The number of high-level visits and exchanges between India and China have increased significantly during Modi's period in office. In 2014, Modi received Xi Jinping in his home state of Gujarat, and Modi made a return visit to Xian and Beijing in May 2015. Exchanges have also taken place at ministerial and other levels, such as meetings of the national security advisors. As a result of comprehensive diplomatic efforts involving multiple levels and actors, encounters between policymakers have often taken place on the sidelines of other multilateral or regional occasions. For example, India's National Security Advisor Ajit Kumar Doval met with Chinese State Councillor Yang Jiechi in relation to the BRICS summit in Xiamen in September 2017, and China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi visited India in December 2017 for the 15th Russia–India–China trilateral.[27] Further meetings between Xi and Modi included the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in China in June and the BRICS summit in South Africa in July 2018.

India and China also engage each other in a number of regional and multilateral forums. Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (BRICS), with annual summits since 2009, has become one important meeting place. Both India and China need energy, raw materials, and access to new markets. Although BRICS could offer a common platform from which to promote their bilateral economic interests,